Chapter 12

O kara roge – Hibiscus fibres for making strings

Joyce Maion



(a) (b) (c)

Figure 1: (a) *O roge* – Coastal hibiscus, (b) *O taporohi roge* – A hibiscus flower, (c) *Kara roge* – Strings made of the hibiscus fibres

(1)	*Bean rake nom to kara roge,*	If you want a string made of hibiscus[1] fibres,
(2)	*ean toro nao momohu tea mosi to vehu roge vai o kobus.*	you must first go and cut a moist hibiscus twig.
(3)	*O vehu roge vai na tahihi vakahu nana.*	The fibres of hibiscus twig are quickly peeled off.

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(4)	*Ean repaa hihi a kapa nae.*	Then you peel its cover off.
(5)	*Hihi kahii bono naono nae.*	You peel it off its wood.
(6)	*O kapa vai to hihi noman, eve to dao raara bono kara roge.*	The cover that you peel off, we call hibiscus fibre.
(7)	*Benam hiki to urisi mene varoto bona vateen,*	When we don't have a wild banana sheath to strap up the backpack,
(8)	*enam repaa varoto nio kara roge.*	we strap it up with a strap made of hibiscus fibres.
(9)	*Meha maa vuri, eori repaa paku bari bono sikioti vaa teo hagi.*	Sometimes they make the skirt for a dance from them.
(10)	*Hihi rori bona kapa roge,*	They peel the hibiscus covers off,
(11)	*eori repaa taono ni bari tahii.*	then they put them in the sea, weighing them down with stones.
(12)	*Beo kapa roge vai o pereperee koava,*	When a green hibiscus cover rots,
(13)	*eori repaa gono takin kahi bari bona tahii.*	they get it out of the saltwater.
(14)	*Murinae eori repaa garuhu bari,*	After that they wash it,
(15)	*eori repaa varoava bari.*	and put it in the sun.
(16)	*Beve raka, eori repaa sirisiri varutarutaa bari.*	When it is dry, they tear it into fine strips.
(17)	*Eori repaa paku bari bono garasi sikioti mene hagi teori.*	Then they use them for making their grass skirt for dancing.

[1] *Hibiscus tiliaceus*